

of the face. We have collected these features in a databank against which the new faces can be matched. It is with calculation methods that the computer automatically concludes which makeup best accentuates and embellishes the facial features of a particular woman," said Kristina Scherbaum, who developed the program.

Software to spy on mobile phones

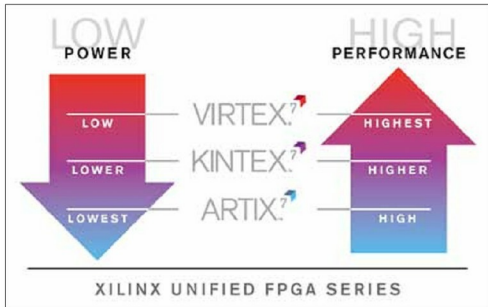
Think your spouse is cheating on you? Retina Software has developed a mobile phone spying application called ePhoneTracker that allows users to monitor every move made on a person's mobile phone including text messages, call info, GPS locations, websites visited, contacts added and retrieved. Even deleted e-mails and texts can be retrieved by the new application, which are mailed directly to the user's inbox.

The software is available for Android, BlackBerry, iPhone, Windows Mobile 6 and Symbian OS 9. Once installed, it starts every time the phone is turned on. The software runs in stealth mode and doesn't show up in the running processes.

World's first 28nm FPGA

Xilinx has begun the rollout of 7 series 28nm FPGAs with shipment of Kintex-7 K325T. Kintex-7 FPGAs are built to provide optimal price performance at the lowest power to meet requirements for key applications. At the same time, these leverage the unified architecture shared across the 7 series, 28nm device families to enable customers to begin FPGA development for designs that may ultimately migrate to Artix-7 and Virtex-7 FPGAs.

The Kintex-7 devices are offered in conjunction with the Xilinx ISE Design Suite 13, AMBA 4 Advanced Extensible Interface (AXI) bus protocol-compliant IP and targeted reference designs. All of these targeted design platform components run on the Kintex-7 FPGA KC705 evaluation board currently being demonstrated for customers so



Xilinx 7 Series FPGAs

that designers can evaluate the power consumption, performance and capabilities of the Kintex-7 K325T devices.

Breakthrough in building 3D transistors

Applied Materials has unveiled the Applied Centura Conformal system that features conformal plasma doping (CPD) technology to enable fabrication of advanced 3D structures in next-generation logic and memory chips.

The Conformal system uniquely combines high-dose, low-energy doping technology with in-situ clean capability in a single vacuum chamber to deliver uniform, high-throughput doping on both planar and 3D structures. Also vital to good device performance is the system's use of a pure, additive-free doping chemistry that preserves the underlying device structures—a critical feature not found in other plasma doping systems.

Doping is a fundamental chipmaking process that modifies the electrical properties of a material by incorporating impurities into its crystal lattice structure. The process is traditionally performed by bombarding the wafer with a beam of dopant ions moving at a high speed. However, this straight-line bombardment process cannot provide uniform doping of advanced

three-dimensional structures. More importantly, fast-moving ions can damage the ultra-thin semiconductor layers in cutting-edge chips.

Some of the advanced devices enabled by the new Conformal system include finFET logic, vertical gate DRAM and vertical NAND flash memory arrays.

Class-H VDSL line driver

Texas Instruments claims to have introduced the industry's first Class-H VDSL line driver. Compared to Class AB alternatives, the gated, dual-port THS6226 consumes 47 per cent less power—a critical requirement for the high-density VDSL applications used in high-speed broadband networks.

By offering a digitally adjustable quiescent current, the THS6226 allows for optimal power savings while still achieving high linearity and low distortion. It also simplifies product sourcing and design by covering all VDSL profiles with a single line driver.

The THS6226's adjustable quiescent current of 7.6 mA to 23.5 mA with a current step of 1 mA provides designers the flexibility to fine-tune the power control. It also offers low multitone power ratio distortion of 70 dB with 19.8 dBm for VDSL2 profile 8b to help maintain signal fidelity.

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